

PEACH ICE CREAM

Makes about 1 quart (1l)

This is the first ice cream that springs to mind when people nostalgically recall hand-cranked fruit-flavored ice creams from their past. For those of us old enough to remember a time before electric ice cream machines, we took turns churning away at the White Mountain with its wooden bucket and oversized handle that got harder to turn the closer the ice cream got to being ready. Our efforts were rewarded after we finally wiped away the salt-crusted ice, removed the lid, and dove in with spoons.

An effortless way to peel peaches is to cut an X in their bottoms and then lower them into a pot of boiling water for about 20 seconds. Using a slotted spoon, transfer the peaches to a colander and shock them by rinsing under cold water. When cool enough to handle, you'll find their fuzzy peels just slip right off.

- 1. Peel the peaches, slice them in half, and remove the pits. Cut the peaches into chunks and add them with the water to a medium, nonreactive saucepan. Cover and cook over medium heat stirring once or twice, until the peaches are soft and cooked through, about 10 minutes. Remove from the heat, stir in the sugar, and then cool to room temperature.
- 2. Once cooled, puree the peaches and any liquid in a blender or food processor with the sour cream, heavy cream, vanilla, and lemon juice until slightly chunky but almost smooth.
- 3. Chill the mixture thoroughly in the refrigerator, then freeze it in your ice cream maker according to the manufacturer's instructions.

VARIATION: To make Nectarine Ice Cream, simply substitute nectarines for the peaches. There's no need to peel the nectarines, because their tender skins soften during cooking.

PERFECT PAIRING: Make a Peaches and Cream Compote. Peel and slice several peaches (allow 2 peaches for 4 people), then toss the slices with a sprinkle of sugar and let stand for about 30 minutes, until juicy. Put a scoop each of the Peach Ice Cream and Crème Fraîche Ice Cream (page 72) in bowls and pile peach slices around them.

- 1½ pounds (600g) ripe peaches (about 4 large peaches)
- ½ cup (125ml) water
- ¾ cup (150g) sugar
- ½ cup (120g) sour cream
- 1 cup (250ml) heavy cream
- ¼ teaspoon pure vanilla extract
- A few drops freshly squeezed lemon juice

PEACH FROZEN YOGURT

Makes about 3 cups (750ml)

I make this with plain, unstrained yogurt. The peach puree is so velvety thick, this frozen yogurt has a lovely consistency without any additional richness.

- 1. Peel the peaches, slice them in half, and remove the pits. Cut the peaches into chunks and add them with the water to a medium, nonreactive saucepan. Cover and cook over medium heat, stirring occasionally, until the peaches are soft and cooked through, about 10 minutes. Remove from the heat, stir in the sugar, and then chill in the refrigerator.
- 2. When the peaches are cool, puree them in a food processor or blender with the yogurt until slightly chunky but almost smooth. Mix in the lemon juice.
- 3. Freeze the mixture in your ice cream maker according to the manufacturer's instructions.

- 1½ pounds (675g) ripe peaches (about 5 large peaches)
- ½ cup (125ml) water
- ¾ cup (150g) sugar
- 1 cup (240g) plain whole-milk yogurt
- A few drops freshly squeezed lemon juice

PERFECT PAIRING: Serve Peach Frozen Yogurt with a summertime Mixed Berry Coulis (page 198).

TWEAKING THE TANG

Frozen yogurt is a popular alternative to ice cream not only because it's less rich but also because it has an appealing, lively acidity. When paired with fruits, its flavors are highlighted by the contrast between sweet and tart.

After yogurt has been sweetened and churned, that tang can become less pronounced. To add a bit of extra zing to frozen yogurt, stir ¼ teaspoon of citric acid into the mix (for any recipe that yields 1 quart, 1l). Citric acid, which is naturally found in citrus fruits, is sold in crystallized form; it resembles coarse salt. You can find it online, and some pharmacists carry it. You can also use Fruit Fresh, which is used by canning enthusiasts to raise acidity and prevent browning; it is available in supermarkets. Citric acid is a prominent ingredient in Fruit Fresh, but it is not the only one. So you may want to sprinkle in a little more of it than if using pure citric acid.